

AI & Tech News Digest

Evening Edition -- Today's Top Stories

Monday, August 03, 2026

1

Alibaba's Qwen3.8-Max Targets US AI Supremacy With Advanced Coding Features

Chinese tech giant Alibaba has officially unveiled its largest and most capable AI model to date, named Qwen3.8-Max. Developers and benchmark reports indicate that the model sets an entirely new performance standard for code generation and collaborative coworker tasks. Alibaba claims the new architecture rivals the leading proprietary systems developed by US frontier labs like OpenAI and Anthropic. Because it is positioned as an open-weight offering, it provides developers worldwide with massive capability improvements for local and enterprise deployments.

Why it matters:

The relentless progress of open-weight models means engineering teams no longer have to rely exclusively on expensive, locked-down US cloud APIs for top-tier coding assistance. This levels the playing field for global software development.

Source: The Verge | <https://www.theverge.com/ai-artificial-intelligence/974342/alibaba-qwen-max-open...>

2

Cybersecurity Startup Horizon3 Hits \$2 Billion Valuation With \$250M Series E

Cybersecurity firm Horizon3 has successfully raised a \$250 million Series E funding round, skyrocketing its valuation to \$2 billion. The massive capital injection highlights a major market shift as organizations increasingly demand continuous, AI-powered security validation rather than traditional, static annual penetration tests. As AI tools accelerate both defensive capabilities and sophisticated cyberattacks, enterprises are looking for automated ways to continuously audit their networks. Horizon3's platform aims to autonomously find and fix vulnerabilities before malicious actors exploit them.

Why it matters:

Traditional yearly security audits are obsolete in an era of automated, AI-driven threats. Securing modern cloud operations requires real-time, continuous automated validation.

Source: TechCrunch | <https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/03/horizon3-hits-2-billion-valuation-with-250m-se...>

3

Samsung Cracks Down on Smart TV Apps Routing Residential Proxy Traffic

Samsung has instituted a strict ban on smart TV applications that covertly route and share users' home internet connections with strangers. This policy enforcement follows recent deep-dive security research that exposed how shady residential proxy networks operate through unsuspecting consumer applications. These apps quietly repurpose bandwidth from everyday smart devices, turning home networks into commercial proxy nodes without transparent user consent. Samsung's decisive action establishes a much-needed precedent for consumer IoT safety and platform accountability.

Why it matters:

IoT devices remain a massive blind spot in enterprise and home network security. Platform owners must aggressively police app stores to prevent residential hardware from being weaponized.

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Source: TechCrunch | <https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/03/samsung-bans-smart-tv-apps-that-share-users-in...>